

ISHFAQ MALIK

Data Analytics Engineer

London, UK | 0741 352 3240 | ishfakmalik@hotmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A Data Engineer with 7+ years' experience designing scalable data pipelines, building governed lakehouse architectures, and delivering analytics infrastructure across cloud platforms. Specialist in Microsoft Fabric and Databricks, working across the full data engineering lifecycle — from ingesting raw data through ODBC and API sources to building medallion architectures, optimising Delta Lake operations, and delivering clean, reliable data to business stakeholders. Experienced in building data functions from the ground up, establishing governance frameworks, and embedding data-driven culture across cross-functional teams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced a critical production pipeline from 100+ minutes to under 2 minutes (98% improvement) by redesigning the architecture around incremental Delta merges, eliminating redundant operations, and migrating performance-critical workloads from Dataflows to notebooks — cutting Azure compute consumption from 2.4 million CUs to a fraction of that.
- Built end-to-end data pipelines from scratch across multiple domains (orders, products, components, print run data), integrating OpenEdge databases, SharePoint, and cloud storage into unified Fabric Lakehouses.
- Engineered features and data preprocessing for ML-driven markdown optimisation at a major UK retailer, directly improving model performance and supply chain decision-making across thousands of product lines.
- Established data governance frameworks including lineage tracking, access control, and quality automation for lakehouse environments.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Data Platforms	Microsoft Fabric, Databricks (Delta Lake, Unity Catalog, DLT), Azure Synapse
Pipeline & ETL Architecture	Azure Data Factory, PySpark, Python, SQL, SSIS, Databricks Asset Bundles
Governance	Medallion Architecture (Bronze/Silver/Gold), Delta Lakehouse, Incremental Loading
CI/CD & DevOps	Unity Catalog, Data Lineage, Access Control, Data Quality Automation
BI & Analytics	GitHub Actions, Databricks CLI, Git, Service Principal Auth, Multi-Environment Deployment
ML & Advanced	Power BI (DAX, Data Modelling), Tableau, Self-Service Analytics
	Scikit-Learn, Predictive Modelling, Feature Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aura Brand Solutions, Remote
Data Analytics Engineer

Sep 2024 – Present

- Designed and built scalable ETL pipelines using Python, SQL, and Azure Data Factory, ingesting and transforming data from ODBC and API sources into a Delta Lakehouse on Microsoft Fabric following a medallion architecture.
- Achieved a 98% reduction in pipeline runtime (100+ min to <2 min) by rearchitecting around incremental Delta merges and replacing Dataflows with notebooks for performance-critical workloads, reducing Azure CU consumption from 2.4M to under 50K.
- Built end-to-end data pipelines from scratch across orders, products, components, and print run domains, integrating OpenEdge databases, SharePoint, and cloud storage into unified Fabric Lakehouses.
- Created optimised data models and fact/dimension tables in SQL to support reporting and self-service analytics.

- Designed and published Power BI reports and dashboards with advanced DAX measures for real-time business insights.
- Implemented data governance best practices including data lineage, documentation, and access control.

Career break – travel (Europe and Asia)

Apr 2024 – Aug 2024

Marks & Spencer, London

Aug 2021 – Mar 2024

Data Analyst – Advanced Analytics, Digital Products

- Worked within the Digital Products team across Markdown Optimisation, Allocation & Replenishment, and Inventory Dashboard projects, bridging analytics and data engineering.
- Engineered features and conducted data preprocessing for ML-driven Markdown Optimisation using Databricks and PySpark, improving model accuracy and enabling more effective pricing decisions across thousands of SKUs.
- Developed robust ETL pipelines in Python for data transformation, model tracking, and downstream BI consumption.
- Applied machine learning techniques (Scikit-Learn) for trend forecasting and allocation logic optimisation, improving resource efficiency across the supply chain.
- Processed and transformed high-volume retail transactional data for operational reporting and business intelligence.

RIBA (Royal Institute of British Architects), London

Oct 2018 – Jul 2021

Data Analyst

- Extracted and analysed data from multiple databases using SQL, enabling data-driven decision-making across the organisation.
- Built automated reports and dashboards using Power BI and SSIS, replacing manual reporting processes.
- Optimised the eBIS application by introducing a new workflow that accelerated expenditure approvals.
- Improved CRM systems efficiency through development of ETL and reporting processes.

Pairview Limited, London

Dec 2017 – Sep 2018

Data Analyst

- Built predictive models using Python (Jupyter Notebook) for business forecasting and decision support.
- Created reports and dashboards in Tableau and Excel, analysing data from multiple databases and warehouses.
- Performed data modelling, cleansing, correlation analysis, and clustering using Python.

EARLIER CAREER

Account Manager | DYH Ltd, London | 2014 – 2017

Business Analyst | Infurn Ltd, London | 2012 – 2014

B2B account management, sales performance reporting, KPI dashboards, requirements gathering, and stakeholder collaboration.

Crew Trainer/Member | McDonalds, Cambridge | 2011 - 2012

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Databricks Certified Data Engineer Professional 2026** — Databricks
- **Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate 2026** — Databricks